

is an activity which is focused towards gaining credibility amongst one's peers. Malicious intent is not always the case.

The Fappening, which is the term being used to describe the massive leak of celebrity nude images, was an unintended blowout according to some reports. What really happened was that these images were not obtained in one single attack, but a series of attacks that had been taking place over a period of years. An underground trading circle had come into being, where these images were treated like a game of trading cards.

There are collectors who pay insane amounts of money for each image and maintaining exclusivity of images only garnered a higher value for the said images. One of these traders tried selling outside the circle and resulted in the happening of 'The Fappening'. What has seen the light of day is but only the tip of a much bigger set of nudies.

What's interesting about the fappening, from a hacker's point of view, is that the majority of the attacks weren't even complex hacks. All it took was a bit of stalking and social engineering. Creepy as that may sound, this is how easy it is for you to get hacked.

What if they're out to get you?

Let's say you're an average guy living in the city with a steady job and you stay with your significant other in a pretty good neighbourhood. The house has a neat electronic security system in place, one of the top brands available. A really good wireless router ensures uninterrupted Wi-Fi access to every corner of the house. You always travel with your smartphone and your smartwatch. It's relatively new but you're one of those early adopters. An 8-inch tablet is always within reach, you never know when boredom could strike. You're pretty much laden with electronics all around you, there's even a Spinal Cord Stimulator implant to relieve you of the mind-numbing pain that resulted from an injury a few years back.

Somewhere out there is a person who wishes to cause you harm. A cracker has been contracted and you couldn't have made it any easier for him by surrounding yourself with all sorts of electronic gadgets. Why don't we go through



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everything that the cracker can manage with current gen technology? This ain't the Matrix, everything mentioned in this article is possible, as has been demonstrated in multiple security and hacking related conferences.

Compromise your property

So you've got a nice car with remote GPS lock and it also upgrades its firmware on the fly thanks to GSM technology. This is where the cracker uses something called an IMSI (International Mobile Subscriber Identity) catcher. Researchers who came up with the GSM standard in the 80's were under pressure to make encryption really weak. However, encryption doesn't even come into the picture here since all GSM handsets are designed to follow instructions sent by the GSM antenna to which they are linked. So all the IMSI catcher has to do is tell your GSM device

or your phone to disable A5 encryption and your phone does it without your approval. Now the cracker has free access to not only your smart car but also your mobile phone and can listen in on every conversation. Even if the cracker has to break the encryption, the KASUMI and MISTY1 algorithms, which are the most prevalent in networks worldwide, they have been cracked since 2010 so it's just a matter of minutes for the attacker.

So what would you need if you were to do the same? A pair of RFX900 daughterboards which cost \$790 each, a synchronisation device for GSM antennae called ClockTamer that is priced at \$250 and a laptop with Debian installed along with OpenBTS and Asterisk. This setup is enough to capture voice and SMS data where time isn't that big a factor.

With all of this in hand, not only can the attacker take over your identity but also put your life at risk in numerous ways. Your home security system's fire safety module can be turned off, your vehicle could be made to shut down while you're on the expressway (With driverless cars, just imagine the carnage!). The attacker could masquerade as you and ask any of your loved ones to meet up at any place and kidnap them. The possibilities are endless, with each one being more shocking than the former.

Compromise your portable devices

Once your property has been taken care of, it's time to target your gadgets. Your



Doesn't matter what kind of encryption is used if you use weak passwords like "iloveyou"